

Where did the Philistines come from?

- The Philistines are descendants of Mizraim son of Ham son of Noah.
- They migrated, similar to some of their brethren, from a place called “Caphtor”.

Noah → Ham → Mizraim → Casluhim → Philistim/Philistines

Genesis 10:6-14

- ⁶ And the sons of **Ham**; Cush, and **Mizraim**, and Phut, and Canaan.
- ⁷ And the sons of Cush; Seba, and Havilah, and Sabtah, and Raamah, and Sabtechah: and the sons of Raamah; Sheba, and Dedan.
- ⁸ And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to be a mighty one in the earth.
- ⁹ He was a mighty hunter before the LORD: wherefore it is said, Even as Nimrod the mighty hunter before the LORD.
- ¹⁰ And the beginning of his kingdom was Babel, and Erech, and Accad, and Calneh, in the land of Shinar.
- ¹¹ Out of that land went forth Asshur, and builded Nineveh, and the city Rehoboth, and Calah,
- ¹² And Resen between Nineveh and Calah: the same *is* a great city.
- ¹³ And **Mizraim** begat Ludim, and Ananim, and Lehabim, and Naphtuhim,
- ¹⁴ And Pathrusim, and **Casluhim, (out of whom came Philistim**^{H6430}), and Caphtorim^{H3732 (H3731)}.

1 Chronicles 1:8-12

- ⁸ The sons of **Ham**; Cush, and **Mizraim**, Put, and Canaan.
- ⁹ And the sons of Cush; Seba, and Havilah, and Sabta, and Raamah, and Sabtechah. And the sons of Raamah; Sheba, and Dedan.
- ¹⁰ And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to be mighty upon the earth.
- ¹¹ And **Mizraim** begat Ludim, and Ananim, and Lehabim, and Naphtuhim,
- ¹² And Pathrusim, and **Casluhim, (of whom came the Philistines**^{H6430}), and Caphthorim^{H3732 (H3731)}.

- Caphtorim/Caphthorim is one of Casluhim's brothers.

Exodus 13:17

And it came to pass, when Pharaoh had let the people go, that God led them not through the way of the land of the **Philistines**^{H6430}, although that was near; for God said, Lest peradventure the people repent when they see war, and they return to Egypt:

The shortest route to Canaan would have been following the trade route along the Mediterranean coastline (northern Sinai peninsula) indicating that the Philistines were settled west of the land of Canaan at least 40 years before the Israelites.

Deuteronomy 2:23

And the Avims^{H5761} which dwelt in Hazerim, even unto Azzah^{H5804}, the Caphtorims^{H3732}, which came forth out of **Caphtor**^{H3731}, destroyed them, and dwelt in their stead.)

- Hazerim is unknown. The Avites^{H5761} are listed in **Joshua 13:3** as land which is yet to be claimed. In **Joshua 18:23** that land is listed as given to the tribe of Benjamin.
- Azzah is another name for Gaza.
- The Caphtorims destroyed the Avims and dwelt in their stead.

Jeremiah 47:4 Because of the day that cometh to spoil all the Philistines^{H6430}, and to cut off from Tyrus and Zidon every helper that remaineth: for the LORD will spoil the Philistines^{H6430}, the remnant of the country^{H339} of Caphtor^{H3731}. Amos 9:7 Are ye not as children of the Ethiopians unto me, O children of Israel? saith the LORD. Have not I brought up Israel out of the land of Egypt? and the Philistines^{H6430} from Caphtor^{H3731}, and the Syrians from Kir?	• This is the only instance of H339 being translated as country. Everywhere else it is translated as “isles” or “islands” (35x). This is our only hint from the Bible as to the location of “Caphtor”. • And so the “isles/island of Caphtor” is probably not a far stretch. • The children of Casluhim and Caphtorim dwelt near each other for a time on Caphtor and they both left.
Zephaniah 2:4-7 ⁴ For Gaza^{H5804} shall be forsaken, and Ashkelon a desolation: they shall drive out Ashdod at the noon day, and Ekron shall be rooted up. ⁵ Woe unto the inhabitants of the sea coast, the nation of the Cherethites^{H3774}! the word of the LORD is against you; O Canaan, the land of the Philistines, I will even destroy thee, that there shall be no inhabitant. 1 Samuel 30:13-16 ¹³ And David said unto him, To whom <i>belongest</i> thou? and whence <i>art</i> thou? And he said, I <i>am</i> a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days ago I fell sick. ¹⁴ We made an invasion upon the south of the Cherethites^{H3774}, and upon <i>the coast which belongeth</i> to Judah, and upon the south of Caleb; and we burned Ziklag with fire. ¹⁵ And David said to him, Canst thou bring me down to this company? And he said, Swear unto me by God, that thou wilt neither kill me, nor deliver me into the hands of my master, and I will bring thee down to this company. ¹⁶ And when he had brought him down, behold, <i>they were</i> spread abroad upon all the earth, eating and drinking, and dancing, because of all the great spoil that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah. Ezekiel 25:16 Therefore thus saith the Lord GOD; Behold, I will stretch out mine hand upon the Philistines^{H6430}, and I will cut off the Cherethims^{H3774}, and destroy the remnant of the sea coast.	• The Philistines are also referred to as “Cherethites” and “Cherethims”. • Since they are dwelling on the sea coast this indicates that this is chronologically after their departure from Caphtor. • The Cherethites were from Gath so the young man is describing the Amalekites attacking the south of Gath. • Ziklag (~23 miles southwest of Gath) was given to David and so v16 reinforces that “the south of the Cherethites” is Philistine land. • This also tells us that the Amalekites most likely headed northeast through the valley during their invasion.
2 Samuel 15:18 And all his servants passed on beside him; and all the Cherethites^{H3774}, and all the Pelethites^{H6432}, and all the Gittites^{H1663}, six hundred men which came after him from Gath, passed on before the king.	The “Cherethites”, “Pelethites”, and “Gittites” are all Philistians.